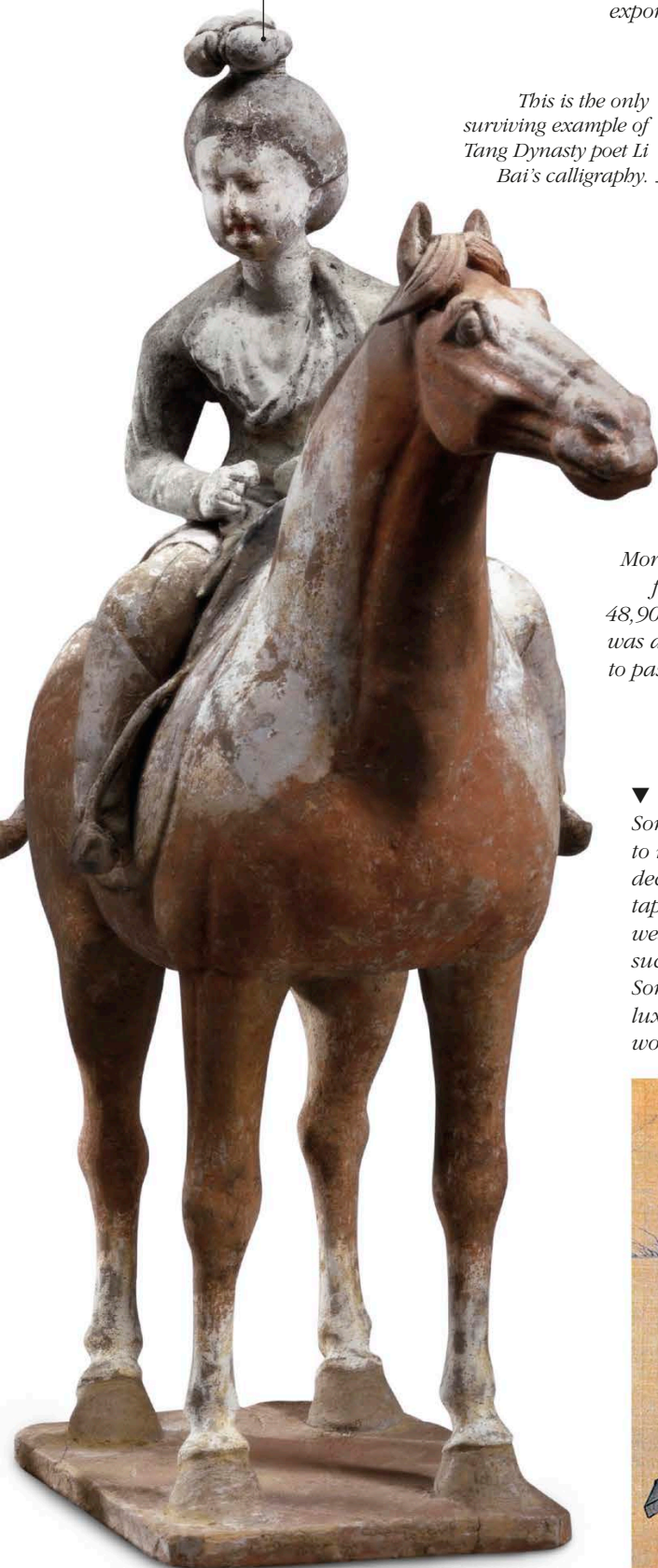


Women rode for both hunting and pleasure.



PORCELAIN ►

The technique for making porcelain was perfected around 700. It was manufactured using clay for the body, ash for the glaze, and minerals to make the pigments. Tang Dynasty porcelain was exported as far as Africa.

Dragon-shaped porcelain detail



This is the only surviving example of Tang Dynasty poet Li Bai's calligraphy.



POETRY ▲

The Tang period was a golden age of poetry in China. More than 3,000 poets are recorded from this time, along with about 48,900 of their poems. Writing poetry was a skill required for those wishing to pass civil exams. One of the famed poets of this time was Li Bai.

▼ SILK

Song women wove silk threads to make into clothes and to be decorated and hung as wall tapestries, while professional weavers created prized fabrics such as brocades and damasks. Song Brocade—China's most luxurious silk today—was woven during this period.



▲ LANDSCAPE PAINTING

Under the Song, the subjects typically depicted in paintings shifted from people and events at court to dramatic landscape scenes. Brush strokes were more important than color, which was used sparingly. Landscape painting reached new heights in this period.